

Unit 4 assessment

Unit summary

A professional standard is a written, shared, evidence-specific statement of what competent practice looks like. It differs from a code of conduct, which governs behaviour, and from a curriculum, which governs content. It does not prescribe method. Standards serve four uses - initial training, continuing development, appraisal and public accountability - and those uses pull against one another, which is the source of most complaints that standards are irrelevant bureaucracy.

Pakistan's National Professional Standards for Teachers, issued in 2009 by the Ministry of Education with UNESCO and USAID support, are the framework this country's teacher education is built to. They are set out in three levels: ten standards, each divided into knowledge and understanding, dispositions, and performance and skills, with indicators stating observably what meeting a part looks like. The three-part division separates knowing, valuing and being able to do. Good indicators are observable, specific and achievable, and there is a standing trade-off in which the easiest indicators to check are the most likely to measure a producible proxy.

Self-evaluation is a five-station cycle run on one indicator at a time: choose, collect, judge, change, re-collect. It breaks by taking on too much and by improving the record rather than the practice. Kinds of evidence are not equivalent, and triangulating two that fail differently beats collecting one thoroughly.

Certification confirms preparation, licensing confirms current permission to practise, and appraisal is the recurring judgement of serving practice. Appraisal serves formative and summative purposes whose requirements pull against each other: candour against comparability, a trusted appraiser against a distant one, weakness against strength. A combined instrument will be treated as summative and the formative value lost. The remedy is separate, deliberately connected processes rather than abandoning accountability.

Summative assessment

Multiple-choice questions (MCQs)

1. A professional standard answers which question? (*Understand*)
 - a) How should I behave?
 - b) What does competent practice look like, in a checkable form?
 - c) What should pupils learn?
 - d) Which teaching method is correct?
2. "Be a good teacher" fails as a standard chiefly because it is not: (*Remember*)
 - a) written down
 - b) shared across schools
 - c) approved by a ministry
 - d) specific enough to be evidenced
3. A framework built for continuing development is used to decide promotions. This is best described as: (*Apply*)
 - a) applying a standard for a use it was not designed for
 - b) efficient reuse of an existing instrument
 - c) a breach of the code of conduct
 - d) summative appraisal working as intended
4. Pakistan's National Professional Standards for Teachers were issued in: (*Remember*)
 - a) 1999 by the Higher Education Commission
 - b) 2015 by NACTE
 - c) 2009 by the Ministry of Education
 - d) 2009 by UNESCO alone
5. Each of Pakistan's standards is internally divided into: (*Remember*)
 - a) aims, methods and outcomes

- b) knowledge and understanding, dispositions, and performance and skills
- c) novice, proficient and expert levels
- d) primary, elementary and secondary bands

6. Which is the strongest indicator for a learning-environment standard?

(Apply)

- a) Maintains a positive classroom climate
- b) Displays pupils' work on the classroom walls
- c) Keeps an up-to-date seating plan
- d) Pupils volunteer answers, including incorrect ones, without prompting

7. In the self-evaluation cycle, evidence is collected before the judgement is formed because: *(Understand)*

- a) it is quicker
- b) the appraiser requires it in that order
- c) a judgement formed first selects the evidence that confirms it
- d) evidence is harder to collect afterwards

8. Which evidence type is easiest to produce without the underlying competence? *(Understand)*

- a) Planning documents
- b) Pupil voice
- c) Pupil work
- d) Observation by a colleague

9. Licensing differs from certification chiefly in that licensing asks: *(Understand)*

- a) was this person prepared?
- b) is this person currently fit to practise?
- c) how is this person doing this year?
- d) which subject may this person teach?

10. A single appraisal document serving both formative and summative purposes will in practice be treated by teachers as: *(Understand)*

- a) formative, because development matters more
- b) neither, because it will be ignored
- c) summative, because that is the version with consequences
- d) both equally

Restricted-response questions (RRQs)

1. Certification, licensing and periodic appraisal all apply the same standards at different career points. State what question each one asks, and explain why a teacher can hold a valid certificate and still fail a licensing requirement. (*Understand*)
2. Distinguish a professional standard, a code of conduct and a curriculum by the question each answers and what each governs, and name one way national standards frameworks differ from one another. (*Understand*)
3. Name the four uses a standard is put to, state what each use requires of the standard, and explain why any two of those requirements pull against each other. (*Understand*)
4. Explain why a standard designed for development and one designed for accountability pull against each other, and what a system must decide in advance if it wants one document to serve both. (*Analyze*)
5. Describe the three-level architecture of Pakistan's National Professional Standards, and explain why the ten standards cannot all be evidenced in the same way. (*Understand*)
6. Explain what separating knowledge, dispositions and performance within a standard buys that a single judgement would not. (*Understand*)
7. Give three tests of a good indicator, and explain why an indicator that is easy to check is often worse. (*Analyze*)
8. Name the five stations of the self-evaluation cycle, identify the two places it commonly breaks, and explain for each break why it makes the cycle unable to show whether anything changed. (*Understand*)

9. For any three evidence types, state what each shows well, what it cannot show, and how easily it can be produced without the competence.
(Understand)
10. Explain why a mentor who also writes a teacher's appraisal is less useful as a mentor, and what this costs a school. *(Analyze)*

Extended-response questions (ERQs)

1. A district must decide whether to confirm two probationary teachers, one well-liked with a quiet class and one difficult with adequate results. Argue whether introducing a written standard would improve that decision, addressing the objection that evidence requirements favour the compliant over the effective. *(Evaluate)*
2. **Integrative.** A teacher is described as follows: she plans thoroughly, marks late, knows her subject well, rarely changes her approach when pupils struggle, and has a warm but quiet classroom in which four pupils do all the answering. Map this practice to specific standards and to the knowledge, dispositions or performance part in each case, then argue what her appraisal should say and what her development priority should be.
(Analyze)
3. Write an indicator for any standard that is observable, specific and achievable in an under-resourced government school. Then explain in detail how a teacher could satisfy it without the underlying competence, and revise the indicator to close that gap. *(Create)*
4. Nadia's self-evaluation was complete and useless; Kashif's looked worse and was not. Evaluate both, diagnose what in a school's handling produces Nadia's behaviour, and design arrangements that would produce more Kashifs while preserving accountability. *(Evaluate)*
5. A province decides that the annual developmental self-evaluation will now also determine promotions. Evaluate the reform, trace the mechanism by which it degrades the record, and propose an alternative that still delivers evidence-based promotion. Address the objection that two separate processes are unaffordable. *(Evaluate)*

Answers and marking guidance

MCQ answer key

1. **b** - a standard governs practice. "How should I behave?" is the question a code of conduct answers, and "What should pupils learn?" is the curriculum's.
2. **d** - it fails the evidence-specificity test; it could be written and shared and still be unusable.
3. **a** - the four uses make this diagnosis available, and it is the province's error in Topic 4.4.
4. **c** - Ministry of Education, 2009, with UNESCO and USAID support.
5. **b** - knowledge and understanding; dispositions; performance and skills.
6. **d** - observable, specific, and genuinely hard to produce without the competence. Displaying pupils' work on the walls is the proxy trap: it is easy to arrange and shows nothing about whether the climate is safe to be wrong in.
7. **c** - order protects against confirmation, which is why Kashif counted before concluding.
8. **a** - planning documents evidence an afternoon's writing, not a term's teaching.
9. **b** - licensing is about current permission and can be renewable; certification is about preparation.
10. **c** - rational response to where the consequences sit, not a failure of maturity.

RRQ model answers and mark schemes

1. (4 marks) Certification asks whether this person was prepared (1); licensing asks whether they are currently fit to practise (1); periodic appraisal asks how they are doing this year (1); explains that certification is a judgement about past preparation and does not expire, while licensing is a judgement about present fitness and can lapse or be withdrawn, so the two can disagree about the same teacher (1).

2. (7 marks) Two marks per instrument: the question it answers and what it governs. Standard: what competent practice looks like, governs practice. Code: how to behave, governs conduct. Curriculum: what pupils learn, governs content. One further mark for naming a real way national frameworks differ, for example in scope, in granularity, or in whether they carry licensing consequences; accept any difference the unit's topic-01 supports.

3. (8 marks) One mark per use named (4); one mark per apt requirement (3); one mark for naming a real tension between two requirements, for example that development needs a standard safe to admit failure against while accountability needs one precise enough to carry a consequence (1). Initial training needs alignment with preparation; development needs generosity and safety; appraisal needs precision and evidence; accountability needs a public claim.

4. (4 marks) Development needs candour and appraisal penalises it (1); development is best with a trusted appraiser, accountability needs distance (1); development targets weakness, accountability invites strength (1); concludes that a system serving both must settle in advance which purpose each conversation carries, because otherwise the summative purpose wins by default (1). Do not award an answer whose conclusion is that one document cannot hold both: topic-04 teaches, from Isore's own wording, that the purposes are conflicting but not incompatible.

5. (5 marks) Ten standards, each a broad area of professional competence (1); each divided into knowledge and understanding, dispositions, and performance and skills (2); indicators beneath the parts, stating observably what meeting a part looks like (1); explains that the ten mix knowledge areas, practices, a values area and a subject-specific area, so they are not parallel and cannot all be evidenced the same way (1).

6. (4 marks) Identifies three distinct shortfalls: not knowing, not valuing, not able (2); explains that each has a different remedy (1); notes that a single judgement hides which applies (1).

7. (5 marks) Observable, specific to the standard, achievable under real conditions (3); easy indicators tend to measure proxies (1); proxies can be produced without the competence (1).

8. (9 marks) Choose one indicator, collect evidence, judge the gap, plan one change, re-collect the same evidence (5); breaks by taking on too many indicators (1); breaks by changing the evidence rather than the practice (1); explains that too many indicators leave each one measured too thinly to attribute a change to anything (1); explains that changing the evidence makes the comparison meaningless, because station five no longer measures what station two did (1).

9. (9 marks) Three marks per evidence type: what it shows, what it cannot show, ease of production without competence.

10. (4 marks) A teacher will not bring a real problem to someone who reports on them (1); the mentoring relationship is the cheapest effective development mechanism a school has (1); its loss is invisible because nothing visibly fails (1); the school retains the appearance of mentoring without the function (1).

ERQ rubrics

Each ERQ is marked out of 20 across four criteria. A response not reaching "Adequate" on the analysis, evaluation or creation criterion cannot exceed 10 overall.

ERQ 1 - Would a standard improve the confirmation decision?

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Grasp of the concept	Praises standards generally	Uses the three features	Shows what specifically changes in the head's report
Identification of use	Not addressed	Names the use	Shows why the use determines what the standard must contain
Objection engaged (Evaluate)	Ignored or dismissed	Answered	Concedes the risk that evidence favours the compliant and locates

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
			what in the design does or does not prevent it
Specificity	Abstract	Some concrete detail	States what the report would have to contain instead

ERQ 2 - Integrative mapping of a described teacher

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Standard mapping	One or two, loosely	Several, correctly	Each practice mapped to standard and to the correct internal part
Use of the three-part division	Absent	Applied once	Distinguishes knowing, valuing and being able across the described behaviours
Appraisal judgement (Analyze)	Lists strengths and weaknesses	Reaches a judgement	Argues a single development priority and justifies why it is prior to the others
Evidence discipline	Inference as fact	Distinguishes them	Names what evidence is missing to decide

ERQ 3 - Writing and hardening an indicator

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Initial indicator	Fails a test	Meets all three tests	Achievable under genuinely constrained conditions
Gaming account	Vague	A plausible route	A route a real teacher would actually take
Revision (Create)	Cosmetic	Closes the gap	Closes it without making the indicator unobservable or unachievable
Reasoning	Asserted	Explained	Explains the proxy trade-off being managed

ERQ 4 - Two self-evaluations and a system

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Analysis of the forms	Praises honesty	Explains professional value of each	Shows why the better one looks worse
Diagnosis	Blames Nadia	Locates cause partly in the system	Locates it fully in the handling, without excusing
Design (Create)	Slogans	Concrete arrangements	Specifies separation and the defined connection, adoptable by a real school

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Accountability preserved (Evaluate)	Not addressed	Addressed	Shows how accountability survives separation rather than being traded away

ERQ 5 - The province's reform

Criterion	Limited (1-2)	Adequate (3)	Strong (4-5)
Mechanism (Analyze)	Asserts morale falls	Describes degradation	Traces it step by step through candour, proxies and mentoring
Command of the distinction	Confused	Accurate	Precise about conflicting requirements
Alternative (Create)	Refuses the aim	Proposes a design	Delivers the legitimate promotion aim and specifies the connection between processes
Cost objection (Evaluate)	Ignored	Acknowledged	Design survives realistic administrative capacity, or states honestly what it would require

Tip: select any text on this page first to comment on that specific passage - or leave nothing selected for general feedback.

Give feedback

